

D260

Health Information Management Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A health system's new policy holds all lab results out of the patient portal for 10 days so physicians can call patients first. The policy applies to every result, and no one reviews individual cases. The system recently won a regional award for patient experience. How is this policy best described?

- A. Likely information blocking, because a blanket delay is not covered by the preventing-harm exception.
- B. Permitted, because it is intended to help patients.
- C. Permitted, since patient-experience results show patients are satisfied.
- D. Permitted under HIPAA's minimum necessary standard.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An HIM director is drafting an environmental scan. The department's coders average twelve years of experience. A new federal rule will require hospitals to share data through standard APIs, and the director sees a chance for HIM to lead that project. Where does the federal rule belong in the SWOT?

- A. Weakness
- B. Opportunity
- C. Strength, because experienced coders can handle it
- D. Strength

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which item belongs in the Weaknesses quadrant of an HIM department's SWOT?

- A. The department's coding accuracy is 97%.
- B. New AI coding tools are entering the market.
- C. The department's outdated scanning equipment causes frequent backlogs.
- D. A competitor is offering low-cost outsourced coding in the region.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A hospital finds that finance, quality, and nursing each report a different 30-day readmission rate because each defines readmission differently. The CIO has proposed buying a new analytics platform. Which action best fixes the root problem?

- A. Buy the analytics platform so reports run faster.
- B. Assign a data steward to set one standard definition and publish it in the enterprise data dictionary.
- C. Have IT decide the definition alone.
- D. Let each department keep its own definition.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A patient asks for an electronic copy of her records sent to her personal email. The hospital's EHR can easily export them as a PDF. She mentions she is switching to a practice across the state. What may the hospital do?

- A. Provide the PDF as requested after explaining email risks, charging at most a reasonable cost-based fee.
- B. Send only paper copies by mail.
- C. Charge a search-and-retrieval fee per page.
- D. Wait for a request from the new practice instead.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hospital cannot fulfill a patient's access request in the first 30 days and sends the patient written notice of the reason and a new date. What is the latest the hospital may act on the request?

- A. 30 days from receipt
- B. 10 business days
- C. 90 days from receipt
- D. 60 days from receipt

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A CDI specialist sees three low sodium results and an order for fluid restriction, but the physician has not documented a related diagnosis. The unit had two nurses call out sick that day. Which query is compliant?

- A. A multiple-choice query listing the lab values and treatment, with options including hyponatremia, other, and clinically undetermined.
- B. A yes/no query asking whether to add hyponatremia.
- C. Please document hyponatremia; it will raise the DRG weight.
- D. Have the coder assign the code from the labs alone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

In March a hospital had 400 Medicare discharges with a combined relative weight of 580. Its average length of stay was 4.6 days, and its base payment rate is \$6,200. What is the case mix index?

- A. \$8,990
- B. 126.1
- C. 0.69
- D. 1.45

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hospital had 500 discharges in each of two quarters. Its CMI rose from 1.30 to 1.40. By how much did total relative weight increase?

- A. 700
- B. 50
- C. 0.10
- D. 7.7%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

As part of her capstone, a new RHIA graduate who plans to relocate to Denver writes several goals for her professional development plan. Which one is written as a SMART goal?

- A. Find a job in Denver.
- B. Get much better at data analytics.
- C. Complete a 40-hour SQL course and build one data-quality dashboard for my department by June 30.
- D. Become the top HIM leader in the country within one year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A laptop holding records for 2,300 patients is stolen from an employee's car. The drive was encrypted to federal standards, and the key was not on the device. The theft happened in a busy parking garage. What breach notification is required?

- A. Notify individuals, HHS, and the media within 60 days.
- B. Notify only if more than 5,000 patients are affected.
- C. Notify HHS within 72 hours.
- D. No breach notification, because the PHI was secured by encryption; document the incident and risk review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Unencrypted paper records for 120 patients are lost, and the risk assessment cannot show a low probability of compromise. What notice is required?

- A. No notice, because fewer than 500 are affected.
- B. Notify the individuals only after a year.
- C. Notify the individuals within 60 days and log the breach for the annual report to HHS.
- D. Notify the media and HHS within 60 days.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A health system's new policy holds all lab results out of the patient portal for 10 days so physicians can call patients first. The policy applies to every result, and no one reviews individual cases. ~~The system recently won a regional award for patient experience.~~ How is this policy best described?

Target word: is this information blocking **Decides:** A blanket delay with no individualized harm determination.

A	Correct	The harm exception requires an individualized determination; routine delays interfere with access.
B	Inverted operation	Good intent does not create an exception.
C	Camouflage	An award does not decide legal compliance.
D	Confusion set	Minimum necessary does not apply to a patient's access to their own information.

2. Answer B Concept 2

An HIM director is drafting an environmental scan. ~~The department's coders average twelve years of experience.~~ A new federal rule will require hospitals to share data through standard APIs, and the director sees a chance for HIM to lead that project. Where does the federal rule belong in the SWOT?

Target word: SWOT quadrant for the rule **Decides:** External factor the department can use to its advantage.

A	Confusion set	Weaknesses are internal and harmful.
B	Correct	It is external and favorable to the department.
C	Camouflage	Coder experience is a separate internal strength, not the rule's quadrant.
D	Adjacent category	Strengths are internal; the rule comes from outside.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Which item belongs in the Weaknesses quadrant of an HIM department's SWOT?

Target word: reverse: find the internal negative **Decides:** Internal and harmful.

A	Inverted operation	Internal and helpful is a strength.
B	Adjacent category	An external trend; usually an opportunity or threat.
C	Correct	Internal and harmful.
D	Confusion set	External and harmful is a threat.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A hospital finds that finance, quality, and nursing each report a different 30-day readmission rate because each defines readmission differently. ~~The CIO has proposed buying a new analytics platform.~~ Which action best fixes the root problem?

Target word: governance fix **Decides:** The issue is inconsistent definitions, not tools.

A	Camouflage	A new tool would still use conflicting definitions.
B	Correct	Stewardship and a shared dictionary fix definitional inconsistency.
C	Adjacent category	IT supports systems; business data owners and stewards own definitions.
D	Inverted operation	Preserves the inconsistency.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A patient asks for an electronic copy of her records sent to her personal email. The hospital's EHR can easily export them as a PDF. ~~She mentions she is switching to a practice across the state.~~ What may the hospital do?

Target word: form and fee for access **Decides:** Electronic copy is readily producible; patient is requesting her own records.

A	Correct	Access must be in the requested form if readily producible, with only cost-based fees.
B	Absolute language	The requested electronic form is readily producible.
C	Adjacent category	Search and retrieval fees are not allowed for patient access.
D	Camouflage	Her move does not change her own right of access.

6. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A hospital cannot fulfill a patient's access request in the first 30 days and sends the patient written notice of the reason and a new date. What is the latest the hospital may act on the request?

Target word: maximum time with extension **Decides:** One 30-day extension is allowed.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the permitted extension.
B	Confusion set	Not the federal HIPAA time limit.
C	Inverted operation	Adds extensions instead of allowing only one.
D	Correct	30 days plus one 30-day extension.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A CDI specialist sees three low sodium results and an order for fluid restriction, but the physician has not documented a related diagnosis. ~~The unit had two nurses call out sick that day.~~ Which query is compliant?

Target word: compliant query **Decides:** Must list indicators and offer options without leading.

A	Correct	Presents indicators and reasonable options without leading.
B	Adjacent category	Yes/no queries should not be used to introduce a new, undocumented diagnosis.
C	Inverted operation	Leading and mentions financial impact.
D	Dropped element	Diagnoses must come from provider documentation.

8. Answer D Concept 6

In March a hospital had 400 Medicare discharges with a combined relative weight of 580. ~~Its average length of stay was 4.6 days, and its base payment rate is \$6,200.~~ What is the case mix index?

Target word: CMI **Decides:** Total weight / number of cases.

A	Adjacent category	$1.45 \times \$6,200$ is an average payment, not the CMI.
B	Wrong stem number	$580 / 4.6$ divides by length of stay.
C	Inverted operation	$400 / 580$ flips the ratio.
D	Correct	$580 / 400 = 1.45$.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

A hospital had 500 discharges in each of two quarters. Its CMI rose from 1.30 to 1.40. By how much did total relative weight increase?

Target word: solve for change in total weight **Decides:** Total weight = CMI × cases.

A	Adjacent category	The new total weight, not the increase.
B	Correct	$(1.40 - 1.30) \times 500 = 50$ (700 – 650).
C	Dropped element	The CMI change without multiplying by cases.
D	Confusion set	The percent change in CMI, not the weight increase.

10. Answer C Concept 7

As part of her capstone, a new RHIA graduate ~~who plans to relocate to Denver~~ writes several goals for her professional development plan. Which one is written as a SMART goal?

Target word: SMART goal **Decides:** Has a measure and a deadline tied to a relevant skill.

A	Camouflage	Tied to the relocation detail, not a development skill, and has no measure or date.
B	Dropped element	No measure or deadline.
C	Correct	Specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound.
D	Absolute language	Not achievable or measurable.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A laptop holding records for 2,300 patients is stolen from an employee's car. The drive was encrypted to federal standards, and the key was not on the device. ~~The theft happened in a busy parking garage.~~ What breach notification is required?

Target word: notification duty **Decides:** Properly encrypted PHI is secured.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the encryption safe harbor.
B	Wrong stem number	No 5,000 threshold exists; 500 sets the HHS and media rule.
C	Confusion set	72 hours is a GDPR timeline, not HIPAA.
D	Correct	The safe harbor applies to properly encrypted data.

12. Answer C Concept 8 · transfer

Unencrypted paper records for 120 patients are lost, and the risk assessment cannot show a low probability of compromise. What notice is required?

Target word: notice for under 500 **Decides:** Fewer than 500 affected; unsecured PHI.

A	Dropped element	Individuals must still be notified.
B	Inverted operation	The annual timing applies to HHS reporting, not to individuals.
C	Correct	Under 500: individuals promptly, HHS on the annual log.
D	Adjacent category	Media and immediate HHS notice apply at 500 or more.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Information blocking	Under the 21st Century Cures Act, providers and health IT actors may not interfere with access, exchange, or use of electronic health information unless a defined exception (e.g., preventing harm, privacy, security, infeasibility) applies.	Assuming a blanket delay is fine if the intent is good.	A policy that routinely holds back results or records from patients or other providers.
2	SWOT in an environmental scan	Strengths and weaknesses are internal; opportunities and threats are external.	Labeling an outside trend as a strength or a department problem as a threat.	Ask whether the factor is inside the organization's control or outside it.
3	Data governance and stewardship	Governance sets enterprise standards and decision rights; data stewards own the definition and quality of specific data elements in a shared data dictionary.	Treating inconsistent data as a technology problem only.	The same term measured different ways by different departments.
4	Patient right of access	Under HIPAA, a covered entity must act on a patient's access request within 30 days (one 30-day extension with written notice), in the requested form if readily producible, for a reasonable cost-based fee.	Charging search-and-retrieval fees or insisting on paper.	A patient asks for their own records, especially electronically.
5	Compliant CDI query	A query presents the clinical indicators and offers reasonable options, including other and clinically undetermined, without leading or mentioning payment impact.	Asking the provider to add a specific diagnosis or citing reimbursement.	Clinical indicators in the record without a matching documented diagnosis.
6	Case mix index	CMI = total relative weights of cases / number of cases.	Dividing by length of stay, or confusing CMI with average payment.	A total relative weight and a case count.
7	SMART professional development goals	A development goal is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.	Writing an aspiration with no measure or deadline.	Choosing among goal statements for a development plan.
8	Breach notification	A breach of unsecured PHI requires notice to individuals within 60 days of discovery; 500 or more also triggers HHS and media notice within 60 days, fewer than 500 goes on an annual log to HHS; properly encrypted PHI is not a reportable breach.	Ignoring the encryption safe harbor or the 500 threshold.	A lost or stolen device or file plus a count of affected patients.

Course scope (public description): The Health Information Management Capstone is the culmination of the student's degree program. The course allows students to do an environmental scan focusing specifically on emerging issues and trends in health information management (HIM) and to apply knowledge learned throughout the program to the problems and issues facing HIM professionals. The student will also develop a professional and educational development plan.